

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

My work began as self-portraiture, and it remains rooted there, but I use self-portraiture less to represent myself than to understand myself. I place my body inside myths, materials, environments, and lived experiences and photograph what happens.

I document my own rituals and encounters so that I can return to them afterward and study who or what I became within them. I work with materials without fully determining in advance what I will do with them, allowing gesture, attraction, resistance, and repetition to emerge intuitively. The photographs become a way of seeing what occurred before I had language for it.

I am interested in what happens when I place my body in relation to something else—to water, landscape, fabric, fruit, flowers, architecture, myth—and allow that relationship to develop. The camera records the encounter. Later, through looking, I begin to understand what the body knew, what the material elicited, and what kind of self emerged between them.

The work uses self-portraiture to investigate embodiment, transformation, ecological identity, inheritance, grief, desire, knowledge, and the relationship between bodies and larger systems.

The body is not treated as a subject to be represented.

It functions as:

- landscape
- threshold
- portal
- archive
- vessel
- witness
- ecological system
- site of encounter

The photographs are less concerned with identity as a fixed condition than with identity as an ongoing process of participation, transformation, and becoming.

Scale and identity

The distance of the camera changes what kind of body appears in the photograph. In some images, the figure remains recognizably me: a portrait of the artist. In others, costume, gesture, setting, or myth allows the figure to operate more like an archetype. As the frame moves closer and the body becomes fragmented, individual identity often falls away. A hand, belly, fold, limb, or patch of skin can become less “my body” than “a body,” or even simply flesh.

At that scale, human flesh becomes one material among the other materials in the photograph—water, stone, fabric, fruit, flowers, light, earth. The image can shift from documenting an individual to studying relationships between forms of matter.

CENTRAL PRACTICE QUESTION

How does a body participate in and emerge from forces larger than itself?

Those forces may include:

- lineage
- ecology
- desire
- seasonality
- grief
- transformation
- weather
- time
- birth
- death
- evolution
- inherited systems

The work is less concerned with overcoming such forces than with understanding forms of participation within them.

CORE THEMES

Agency Within Constraint

One of the strongest recurring inquiries throughout the practice.

The work repeatedly asks:

What forms of agency remain available within conditions that cannot be fully controlled?

Agency is not equated with:

- freedom
- domination
- mastery
- empowerment

Agency may instead appear through:

- participation
- discernment
- tending
- witnessing
- choosing
- remaining present

The work investigates forms of sovereignty that exist alongside:

- grief
 - biology
 - inheritance
 - seasonality
 - vulnerability
 - limitation
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Embeddedness

The self is not treated as autonomous or separate.

Bodies emerge from and remain entangled with:

- landscape
- ecology
- ancestry
- evolution
- matter
- time
- community

The work repeatedly investigates what becomes visible when the self is understood as embedded rather than independent.

This theme appears prominently in:

- Relative
 - Red Thread
 - Body of Water
 - Shelter
 - Membrane
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Permeability

A recurring question:

Where does the self end?

The work investigates:

- membranes
- water surfaces
- openings
- caves
- folds
- distortions
- bodily boundaries
- reflections

Permeability functions simultaneously at:

- bodily scale
 - ecological scale
 - psychological scale
 - relational scale
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Transformation Through Encounter

Transformation is rarely presented as:

- healing
- transcendence
- resolution

Instead:

- immersion

- grief
- disruption
- desire
- bodily change
- seasonal return
- encounter

become the conditions through which transformation occurs.

The work is interested in participation within transformation rather than mastery over it.

Freedom Through Participation

The work repeatedly rejects two familiar narratives:

Complete Autonomy

The fantasy of escaping systems.

Complete Surrender

The fantasy of powerlessness.

Instead the work investigates:

- discernment
- tending
- witnessing
- participation
- negotiated agency

A recurring proposition across multiple projects:

Freedom is not separation.

Freedom is conscious participation.

Reclamation of Female Narrative

The work repeatedly revisits narratives historically framed through:

- temptation
- sin
- weakness
- passivity
- victimhood

Questions include:

- What forms of participation become visible?
- What forms of sovereignty become possible?
- What happens when curiosity, desire, grief, appetite, and transformation are no longer treated as moral failures?

This framework appears most strongly in:

- Fear Not
 - Daffodils
 - Taste and See
 - A Miscarriage
 - Shelter
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PROCESS

Embodied Inquiry

Projects begin with:

- a question
- a state
- a transformation
- a mythic framework
- a lived experience

Images are not previsualized in detail.

Photography functions as discovery rather than illustration.

The artist works through:

- meditation
- embodied attention
- improvisation

- movement
- repetition

Selection occurs after the experience.

Meaning often emerges after the images are made rather than before.

The resulting photographs function as traces of encounters rather than depictions of ideas.

THE BODY AS THRESHOLD

The body is not simply:

- subject
- self-portrait
- symbol

The body repeatedly functions as:

- threshold
- opening
- passage
- membrane
- terrain
- site of encounter

A recurring proposition throughout the work:

The body becomes the portal.

This appears throughout:

- Membrane
 - Threshold
 - Relative
 - Body of Water
 - A Miscarriage
 - Daffodils
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RECURRING VISUAL LANGUAGE

Portal Forms

Manifestations include:

- caves
- navels
- mouths
- eyes
- water surfaces
- bodily openings
- membranes
- reflected surfaces
- dark openings

Associated themes:

- passage
 - permeability
 - encounter
 - emergence
 - transformation
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Circle Forms

Manifestations include:

- navels
- fruit
- openings
- reflected forms
- water surfaces
- bodily centers

Associated themes:

- cycles
- return
- embodiment
- seasonality

Triangle Forms

Manifestations include:

- folded limbs
- gathered flowers
- stretched fabric
- landscape forms
- body arrangements

Associated themes:

- containment
- emergence
- orientation
- tension

Status: observed but not fully mapped.

PRIMARY CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORKS

Persephone

Persephone functions less as narrative subject than conceptual framework.

Key concerns:

- cyclical return
- negotiated sovereignty
- seasonality
- agency within constraint

Guiding phrase:

Powerful and powerless was she.

Eve

The strongest reading is not temptation or fall.

Key concerns:

- curiosity
- choice
- appetite
- participation in knowledge
- self-authorship

The work reclaims narratives of transgression through agency rather than innocence.

Ecological Identity

The self is treated as ecological rather than individual.

Body, landscape, weather, water, plant life, memory, and ancestry operate as interconnected systems rather than separate domains.

Fruiting Body is an ongoing photographic practice

investigating how bodies participate in transformation,

inheritance, ecology, desire, grief, and time. Through

self-portraiture, the body functions not as a subject to be

represented but as a threshold, vessel, landscape, and

site of encounter.

The photographs emerge through embodied inquiry and function as traces of participation within larger systems.

Across multiple projects, the work asks what forms of agency, sovereignty, and freedom remain available within conditions that cannot be fully controlled.

Embeddedness

What happens when we stop imagining ourselves as separate?

This is where the body becomes ecology.

agency

What forms of freedom remain available inside
inevitability?

Not: How do I become free?

But: What kind of freedom exists here?

transformation

How do we move through transformation without
attempting to master it?

This is the territory of passage: an unstable middle.